Introduction to the Modern Eruv

This is the approved revision of this page, as well as being the most recent.

Eruvin*: The Streets, the Strings, and the *Shabbat

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Introduction to the modern day eruv

In order to permit carrying from one domain to another or within a public domain on *Shabbat*, a symbolic enclosure of the area, colloquially known as an eruv, needs to be erected. In terms of *halakhah*, there are three elements necessary to convert a public domain into a private one. The most significant one is a border enclosing the area, whether it is a house, neighborhood, or city. The other elements are a joint partnership between the tenants of the area in the ownership of some food—which usually takes the form of a box of matzah in the local synagogue—and a deed of rental of the area from the local government. The technical term eruv, as it appears in the *gemara*, refers to the food which the tenants jointly own; colloquially, however, it refers to the borders of the enclosure, which is usually the most recognizable element of this legal mechanism as well as the hardest to construct.[1]

In its ideal form, the borders of an eruv would be solid walls. Of course, considering that this possibility is highly impractical in modern society, another approach needs to be investigated. The *gemara* introduced the concept of using *tzurot ha-petah* (symbolic doorways) as a wall. According to the *gemara*, the construction of a doorway requires two doorposts and a lintel sitting on top of the doorposts. Whereas the doorposts have certain requisite measurements, the lintel on top can be as thin as a wire or string. By lining up a number of *tzurot ha-petah* made of these doorposts and lintels, it becomes feasible to erect a complete enclosure of a large city. Even though using *tzurot ha-petah* may be the only practical option in order to construct an eruv, there is one significant caveat to this approach.

Explanations of the *tzurat ha-petah* enclosure

From a biblical perspective, there are two well-defined types of domains: *reshut ha-yahid* (a private domain) and *reshut ha-rabbim* (a public domain). Any other area is considered a *makom patur* (an exempt area). The definition of a *reshut ha-yahid* is an area with the minimum measurement of 4 *tefahim* by 4 *tefahim*[2] that is surrounded by walls of 10 *tefahim* high. A *reshut ha-rabbim*, on the other hand, is a street that is at least 16 *ammot*[2] wide. An open field, then, which is neither enclosed nor used by the public, is considered a *makom patur* on a biblical level. The biblical prohibition of carrying an item from one domain to another only applies to from a reshut ha-yahid to a reshut ha-rabbim or vice versa. Carrying between a *makom patur* and a *reshut ha-rabbim*, or between a *makom*

patur and a *reshut ha-yahid*, would be permitted on a biblical level. To avoid inadvertent violations of *Shabbat,* however, the rabbis introduced a fourth type of domain called a *karmelit*. This category includes some areas that would be considered a *reshut ha-yahid* on a biblical level and some areas that would be considered a *makom patur* on a biblical level. Continuing with our example, while an open field is a biblical *makom patur*, on a rabbinic level it is a *karmelit*. The rabbis forbade carrying from a *karmelit* to a *reshut ha-yahid* or *reshut ha-rabbim*. In effect we treat a *karmelit* like a "public domain" on a rabbinic level. [3]

Although Orthodox Jews generally observe rabbinic enactments with the same zeal as they would observe biblical commandments, the laws of *eruvin* demonstrate an exception to that principle; significant leniencies are based on the fact that many of its details are only rabbinic in nature. There is a general assumption amongst the *poskim* (rabbinic authorities) that an enclosure created by several *tzurot ha-petah* would not be sufficient to circumvent a biblical prohibition against carrying on *Shabbat*. Only once the area can be determined to be a *makom patur*—an area from which carrying to a *reshut ha-yahid* or *reshut ha-rabbim* entails a rabbinic, and not biblical, prohibition —can the construction of an eruv using the *tzurat ha-petah* ensue. In other words, a *tzurat ha-petah* is effective as long as one can be sure that the area is not a true *reshut ha-rabbim*. There are two reasons offered for this assumption.

Rabbi Yosef Teomim, author of an important commentary on the *Shulhan Arukh* called the *Pri Megadim*, raised the possibility that the *tzurat ha-petah* is only effective in enclosing an area according to rabbinic law. According to biblical law, however, the *tzurat ha-petah* is ineffective. Subsequently, using a *tzurat ha-petah* to enclose an area that is considered to be a "public domain" on a biblical level would simply be an insufficient means to convert it into a "private domain." A *karmelit*, however, is considered a *makom patur* on a biblical level and is only considered "public" by the rabbis; thus by erecting a rabbinically sanctioned enclosure, one successfully converts it into a "private domain."[4]

The *Hazon Ish*, Rabbi Avraham Karlitz, however, strongly disagreed with the *Pri Megadim*'s idea. He proved from the *gemara* that a *tzurat ha-petah* certainly functions as a wall on a biblical level. The *gemara* states that in order to avoid *kil'ayim*, the prohibition of planting two different kinds of seeds together, one may construct a *tzurat ha-petah* to divide between the two patches of plants. Therefore, Rabbi Karlitz concluded that the construction of a *tzurat ha-petah* serves as a wall even where the wall fulfills a biblical requirement.[5]

In order to defend the *Pri Megadim*, some later authorities suggested that there is room to distinguish between the wall that is necessary to permit carrying on *Shabbat* and the wall necessary to separate plants of different species. The walls in the realm of *kil'ayim* serve merely as a divider between two areas and as such the *tzurat ha-petah* accomplishes this task even on a biblical level. To permit carrying on *Shabbat*, however, the borders of a "private domain" need to encircle it and make it noticeably differentiated from its surroundings.[6]

Another approach in explaining the basis for limiting the use of a *tzurat ha-petah* enclosure to a *karmelit* emerges from a comment of Tosafot.[7] The *gemara* explains that all opinions agree that a "flimsy barrier" cannot serve as a partition if there is traffic that regularly crosses that barrier, but a "sturdy barrier" functions as a partition even if traffic passes through it. Tosafot commented that if an area is enclosed on three sides and only requires a wall on the fourth side on a rabbinic level, even if the fourth wall is "flimsy" and traffic passes through it, it nonetheless serves as a valid partition. The Maharam of Rotenberg extended the idea of Tosafot to say that in any situation that only requires a wall on a rabbinic level in order to permit carrying, that wall could be "flimsy" and is nevertheless not nullified by the fact that traffic passes through it. Based on the leniency of the Maharam, classical *poskim*

assume that a *tzurat ha-petah* acts as a "flimsy wall" which functions as a partition if the area is only considered a "public domain" on a rabbinic level. Therefore, the consensus of *poskim* is that a *tzurat ha-petah* only permits carrying in the enclosed area if the area would have otherwise only been a biblical *makom patur*.[8]

Determination of a *reshut ha-rabbim*

How does one decide whether any given area is biblically considered a "public domain"? The *gemara* derived the 39 *melahot* (principal categories of labor) prohibited on *Shabbat* from the significant activities done in the construction of the *mishkan* (Tabernacle) in the desert. The *gemara* implicitly assumed that the transportation of the *mishkan* was also included in the mitzvah of constructing the *mishkan*. Therefore, the details of the prohibition against carrying on *Shabbat* can be derived from how the *mishkan* was transported in the desert. The wagons containing the parts of the *mishkan* could only have traveled on streets with a minimum width of 16 *ammot*; thus in order for any area to be considered a "public domain" it must include a street at least 16 *ammot* wide.[9] However, in practice, this definition doesn't help very much since in almost all places where an eruv is desired, the streets are wider than 16 *ammot*.

One of the potential considerations in determining whether a particular area is a *reshut ha-rabbim* is the size of its population. Again, this criterion is based on the derivation of the laws of carrying on *Shabbat* from the transportation of the *mishkan* in the desert. Rashi and Tosafot wrote that just like there were 600,000 people in the Jewish camp in the desert, the definition of a public domain for the purposes of the prohibition of carrying on *Shabbat* requires a minimum population of 600,000.[10] There is a dispute as to whom is included in the count of population when determining the status of an area. The opinions range between counting all residents, counting all people who roam the streets of the area, and counting just the people who walk on a particular street.[11] Based on this assumption, many communities in Eastern Europe relied on a local eruv, considering their small villages and towns to be a *makom patur* (and not a "public domain") on a biblical level.

Ramban[12] explained that the opinion of Tosafot which required a minimum population of 600,000 is limited to streets within a city. For a local street within the city to be considered public, it requires a certain level of usage. In contrast, a highway from one city to another, wrote Ramban, is automatically considered a public domain even without any minimum population simply by its definition as a major public road. It is possible to suggest that Ramban actually *defined* the biblical *reshut ha-rabbim* as a highway, and he viewed all of the guidelines about determining whether a given area is a *reshut ha-rabbim* as a test of whether it is sufficiently similar to a highway or not.

Some rabbis felt that this approach of Rashi and Tosafot in defining a public domain was well-accepted and served as a basis for the modern eruv.[13] Others, however, argued that many *rishonim* (medieval rabbinic authorities) disregarded the idea of Rashi and Tosafot and assumed that there was no minimum population for an area to be considered a *reshut ha-rabbim*.[14] Therefore, other suggestions were offered in order to explain the basis for local *eruvin* in Eastern Europe. The *Arukh HaShulhan* interpreted a passage in the *Yerushalmi* to mean that a "public domain" is defined as a street that is known to be the main street of the town. If there are multiple main streets in town, however, no one of them can be identified as a *reshut ha-rabbim*. Accordingly, the larger the city, the more likely it would be for the multiplicity of streets to cause there to be no particular main street.[15] Yet, the inference of the *Arukh HaShulhan* has traditionally been considered counter-intuitive and has not been accepted.

Another approach to defend the practice of local *eruvin* in Eastern Europe was that of Rabbi Shlomo Dovid Kahana. Rabbi Kahana wrote that a *reshut ha-rabbim* needs to be a street that passes from one end of the city to the other without making any significant turns (*mefulash*). If, however, the main street turns at a right angle or comes to a dead end, the area is considered a *makom patur* on a biblical level. Using this same approach, it is again the case

that the larger the city the more likely it is to be a *makom patur* because of the increased likelihood that there will not be any streets which pass straight through the city. While Rav Moshe Feinstein disagreed with this leniency, Rav Moshe's own original interpretation of this requirement (*mefulash*) is not generally accepted.[16]

It seems reasonable to propose, based on the Ramban mentioned earlier, that a highway that passes through a city is automatically considered a "public domain" by its definition as a public road. Therefore, a highway is not subject to the criterion of passing straight through the city in order to be considered a "public domain." Whereas intracity streets are not considered "public" if they turn or come to a dead end, highways are "public" by definition, irrespective of whether they twist or turn.

The *Hazon Ish*'s model of a citywide eruv

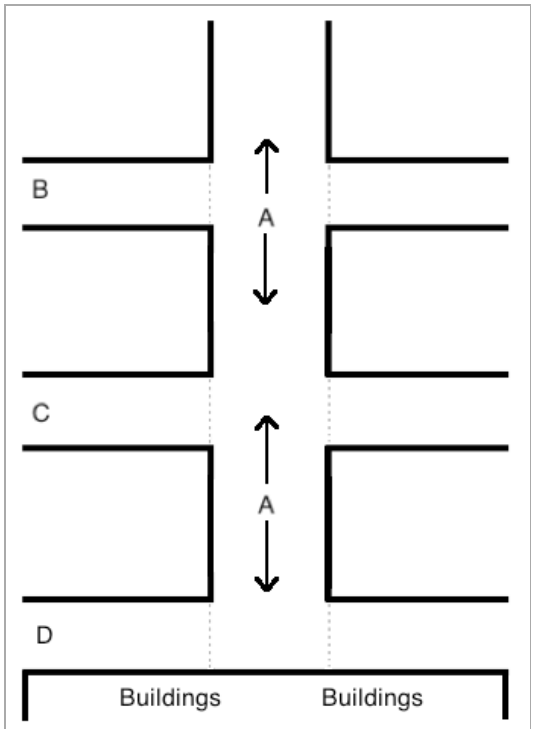
The last major approach to explain how a large city could not be considered a biblical *reshut ha-rabbim* was elucidated by the *Hazon Ish*.[17] The *gemara* establishes that a border which is made up of a number of walls with gaps between them can be considered one long wall if the combined length of its gaps is less than the combined length of the standing walls. This rule is limited to cases in which each gap is less than 10 *ammot* in length; a wall with gaps greater than 10 *ammot* is not considered to be an effective border. While the *Mishkenot Ya'akov* interpreted this to mean that a wall which has gaps greater than 10 *ammot* is not considered a "wall" even on a biblical level, the generally accepted view is that of the *Beit Efrayim* who argued that this would be an effective border on a biblical level, and is only invalid rabbinically.[18]

In major cities such as New York City, it is quite common to have buildings line both sides of the streets without any gaps between buildings, creating a "border" of sorts. Even if each cross street creates a gap in the continuity of the buildings, the majority of such a border would be standing walls and would only have a minority of gaps. Any street that has such buildings on both of its sides can be considered enclosed by two walls on a biblical level, since the buildings form a wall with the majority standing. Lastly, if such a street comes to a dead end where it is met by another wall of buildings, it would then be enclosed by three walls which would make it a biblical *reshut ha-yahid*!

Before expanding this proposition, let us analyze one of our basic assumptions that the buildings that line the streets can serve as a wall for an eruv. The *gemara* states that a *mehitzah* (partition) can serve as a wall for an eruv even if it was not originally intended to be used as an eruv wall when it was constructed. Therefore, the *Hazon Ish* presumed that the buildings which lined the streets could serve as an eruv wall to enclose the street. R. Moshe Feinstein, however, found it difficult to view the walls of a building as a partition that would enclose the street, since they were originally constructed for the purpose of enclosing the inner part of the building and never functioned as a border of the street. Nonetheless, the *gemara* clearly seems to indicate that the *Hazon Ish*'s position is correct.[19]

With that in place, it is possible to take the *Hazon Ish*'s approach one step further. He said as long as it was possible to find one street that came to a dead end in a city, the rest of the city could be considered a *reshut ha-yahid*. According to his explanation, the street which comes to a dead end is considered a *reshut ha-yahid* since both of its sides are lined with buildings and at one end it comes to a dead end. In envisioning the sides of that street as walls, we can view even the gaps in the buildings—i.e. the cross streets—as forming a part of the wall, since a majority of the wall is standing. Now that the junctions between our original dead end street and its cross streets are considered a border, the cross streets become dead ends as well and each one would itself be considered a biblical *reshut ha-*

yahid. By continuing to find the adjacent cross streets from any of these previously determined "private domains," it is possible for the entire city to be considered a *reshut ha-yahid*. It is noteworthy, though, that this last extension of the *Hazon Ish*'s approach is questionable and its correctness can be investigated further.[20]



***Hazon Ish* Diagram** All diagrams are aerial views. Street A, which comes to a dead end and is lined with buildings on both of its sides, can be considered a biblical *reshut ha-yahid* because both its sides have a border made up of a majority of standing walls. The *Hazon Ish* would then proceed to explain that the imaginary lines drawn to complete the closure of Street A serve as a third partition for Streets B, C, and D which would then also become biblical "private domains."

Formation of a *tzurat ha-petah*

The basic idea of a *tzurat ha-petah* is that it resembles a doorframe, which consists of two doorposts and a lintel on top. The doorposts need to be sturdy enough to support a lightweight door that would reasonably be used as a real door in that part of the world and whose width extends from one doorpost to the other (although it only needs to be 10 *tefahim* in height). The farther the doorposts are from one another, the sturdier they have to be in order to support a door that would extend from one post to the other. In actuality, very often the poles of a modern *eruvin* are too wobbly to realistically hold any door, calling into question the validity of these *eruvin*.[21]

Regarding the lintel, the *Shulhan Arukh* followed the version of the *Talmud Yerushalmi* that allows the lintel to be as thin and weak as a string. The Me'iri, however, had a version of the *Yerushalmi* that required the lintel to be strong enough to be able to bolt the door into it for further support. Until today, we follow the *Shulhan Arukh* and allow a string as the lintel.[22]

The *gemara* established that a *tzurat ha-petah* which is poorly constructed in the eyes of a professional architect is invalid. For example, the string serving as a lintel must pass directly over the top of the doorposts and may not be tied around the side of the doorposts; otherwise it is considered "poorly constructed."[23] Similarly, if the doorposts do not touch the ground, even if they are within three *tefahim* of it, the *Hazon Ish* considered this "poorly constructed" and therefore invalid. Although there is a concept of *lavud*, a principle that supposes any two objects within three *tefahim* of one another to be considered as though they were touching, the *Hazon Ish* felt that it may not be employed in construction of a *tzurat ha-petah* since a non-Jewish architect would never use it.[24]

Another case in which a *tzurat ha-petah* is invalid is where the doorposts are misaligned with the gap in the border that this *tzurat ha-petah* would complete. For example, a *tzurat ha-petah* may not serve as a fourth wall of a boundary if its doorposts are to the left or the right of where the fourth wall should be (see diagram #2).[25] Additionally, if the doorpost for a *tzurat ha-petah* is inside of a separate *reshut ha-yahid*, the doorframe is invalid. This situation is possible when one of the doorposts is found inside of a fenced area (see diagram #3).[26]

In conclusion, in order to be able to construct an eruv that would permit one to carry on *Shabbat*, one first must clarify that the area under discussion is biblically a *makom patur* and not a *reshut ha-rabbim*. It is possible for the area not to be considered a "public domain" on a biblical level either because it lacks a population of 600,000 people, because its main street does not go straight through the city, or because buildings line the streets such as the

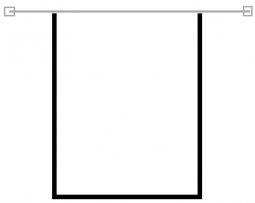


Diagram #2. The bottom, left, and right sides are valid borders and the fourth side is completed with a *tzurat ha-petah*. However, the doorposts for the *tzurat ha-petah* are misaligned, with one to the right and one to the left of where the wall should have been.

case may be in a large city. Once the area is ascertained to be a *karmelit,* which is a *makom patur* on a biblical level, it is possible to erect an eruv using *tzurot ha-petah*. Finally, even if a community has a properly constructed eruv, its residents must ensure that they only use it in accordance with the rest of *hilkhot Shabbat*.[27]

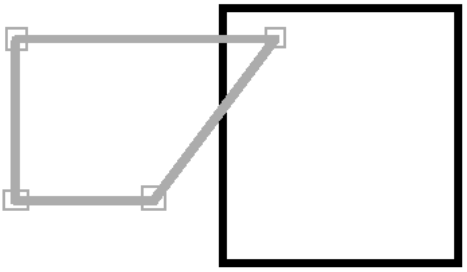


Diagram #3. The black lines represent complete walls and the gray lines represent a *tzurat ha-petah*. One of the *tzurat ha-petah* poles is inside of a private domain.

About

- This article is reprinted with permission from Eruv And Halacha pp. 47-57.
- For practical laws of building an eruv, see the Hotzah page.

Sources

1. The basic requirements of an eruv can be found in Rambam, *Mishneh Torah, Hilkhot Eruvin* 1:1-7 and 2:10 and *Shulhan Arukh Orah Hayyim* 366:1 and 382:1.
2. A *tefah*, or handbreadth, is a measure of length between 3 and 4 inches. An *ammah,* or cubit, is a measure of length between 18 and 24 inches.
3. *Shabbat* 6a, Rambam *Hilkhot Shabbat* 14:1-7, *Shulhan Arukh Orah Hayyim* 345, *Shulhan Arukh ha-Rav* 345:19, *Mishna Brurah* (Introduction to 345), *Arukh ha-Shulhan Orah Hayyim* 345:1.
4. *Bi'ur Halakhah* 362:10 s.v. *ke-she-kol* cites the opinion of the *Pri Megadim*. See also *Bi'ur Halakhah* 364:2 s.v. *ve-ahar*.
5. *Hazon Ish Orah Hayyim* 70:13.
6. An elaboration of this topic can be found in Rabbi Hershel Schachter's *Be-Ikvei ha-Tzon, Siman* 13:1.
7. *Tosafot Eruvin* 22a s.v. *kashya*.
8. *Mordekhai, Eruvin Remez* 509. See further in Rabbi Hershel Schachter's article titled "The Laws of Eruvin—An Overview," *The Journal of Halacha and Contemporary Society* 5 (1984): 131-150.
9. *Shabbat* 99a
10. The discussion of the opinion of Rashi and Tosafot as well as the dissenting opinions can be found in *Tur* and *Shulhan Arukh Orah Hayyim* 345:7. In the Torah's census of the Jewish people, there were found to be slightly over 600,000 men between the ages of 20 and 60. While this number does not include women, children, elderly, and converts, Tosafot (*Eruvin* 6a s.v. *keitzad*) concluded that we can only define a "public domain" based on a number that the Torah states explicitly.
11. *Mishna Brurah* 345:24, R. Moshe Feinstein in *Iggerot Moshe Orah Hayyim* 1:139.
12. *Eruvin* 59a. See further in Rabbi Hershel Schachter's article titled "*Be-Inyan ha-Eruv be-Manhattan*" in *Kol Tzvi* v. 7.
13. *Taz Orah Hayyim* 345:6, *Arukh ha-Shulhan Orah Hayyim* 345:18
14. *Mishkenot Ya'akov Orah Hayyim* 120.
15. *Arukh ha-Shulhan Orah Hayyim* 345:19-25.
16. Rav Moshe Feinstein in *Iggerot Moshe Orah Hayyim* 5:28:6 understood the requirement of having a main street pass from one end of the city to the other as referring to the fact that every part of the street needs to have the dimensions of a public alleyway. He assumed that if one section was roofed or narrower than 16 *ammot* wide, the entire street could not be considered as "a public domain." See also *Iggerot Moshe Orah Hayyim* 140.

17. *Hazon Ish Orah Hayyim* 107:7. Most of his approach is clearly based on the *gemara* and earlier rabbis. However, this approach is nonetheless attributed to the *Hazon Ish* because one aspect of his understanding was at odds with that of Rav Moshe Feinstein. See further in *Be-Ikvei ha-Tzon*, *Siman* 13:5.
18. *Mishkenot Ya'akov Orah Hayyim* 121, *Beit Efrayim Orah Hayyim* 25.
19. See *Eruvin* 15a and *Shulhan Arukh Orah Hayyim* 362:3.
20. *Be-Ikvei ha-Tzon Siman* 13.
21. *Eruvin* 11b, *Shulhan Arukh Orah Hayyim* 362:11.
22. *Meiri Eruvin* 2a and footnote 64 in the *Mossad ha-Rav Kook* Edition by Rav Simcha Zissel Beroida; *Shulhan Arukh Orah Hayyim* 362:11; *Bi'ur ha-Gra ibid*.
23. Even though the *Taz Orah Hayyim* 362:4 was lenient if the string is tied towards the top of the doorpost, his opinion has not been accepted (*Mishna Brurah* 362:64). Additionally, the Maharsham's opinion that this *halakhah* doesn't apply nowadays (Maharsham 1:162) is a nuance not accepted by the *Mishna Brurah*.
24. Even though the *Sha'arei Teshuvah* 363:4 and Steipler in *Kehillat Ya'akov* on *Eruvin Siman* 6 assumed that this was acceptable, the *Hazon Ish Orah Hayyim* 71:11 and 79:11 found this invalid because it does not form a normal doorframe in the eyes of an architect.
25. The Steipler in *Kehillat Ya'akov ibid*. based upon Rabbeinu Yehonatan's commentary on the Rif and *Hazon Ish Orah Hayyim* 70:16-7 agreed that the *tzurat ha-petah* is ineffective if the doorposts of the *tzurat ha-petah* are not in line with the breach in the wall. Regarding the contradictory rulings of the *Hatam Sofer* on this matter, see *Be-Ikvei ha-Tzon Siman 12*.
26. Rabbi Ya'akov of Lissa in *Tikkun Eruvin* s.v. *od ra'iti she-tohavin*, *Avnei Neizer Orah Hayyim* 290
27. One example is playing ball on *Shabbat*. Even if there is an eruv, there are issues involved with playing ball on *Shabbat* including wearing improper clothing for the sanctity of *Shabbat* and nullifying the positive mitzvah of "*shabbaton,"* spiritually resting on *Shabbat*. Regarding playing games on *Shabbat*, see *Arukh ha-Shulhan Orah Hayyim* 308:70 quoting from the *Yerushalmi*. Concerning the mitzvah of resting on *Shabbat*, see Rambam *Hilkhot Shabbat* 1:1, Ramban *Vayikra* 19:2, and Ibn Ezra *Shemot* 20:8.

Category	Topic
Mitzvot of Shabbat	Kiddush Levana - Enjoying Shabbat - Fourth meal of Shabbat - Havdalah - Having a meal on Friday - In the Spirit of Shabbat - Kiddush - Lighting Shabbat Candles - Making Early Shabbat - Making one hundred Brachot on Shabbat - Preparing foods on Shabbat - Preparing for Shabbat - Shenayim Mikrah - Kavod Shabbat - Shabbos Davening - Seudat Shabbat - Seudat Shelishit - Lechem Mishneh - Motzei Shabbat - When Does Shabbat Start?
Restrictions of Shabbat	Allowing Carrying Using an Eruv Chatzerot - Animals on Shabbat - Asking a Jew to work on Shabbat - Asking a non-Jew to work on Shabbat (Amirah LeNochri) - Benefiting from a Violation of Shabbat (Maaseh Shabbat) - Books, notebooks, and papers - Brushing Teeth on Shabbat - Building a structure on Shabbat (Boneh) - Carrying on Shabbat - Cleaning the dishes - Cleaning and Folding Garments on Shabbat - Clearing the table - Cooking (Ofeh and Bishul) - Cosmetics on Shabbat - Dancing and clapping on Shabbat - Electricity on Shabbat - Eruv Chatzerot - Eruvin - Games on Shabbat - Getting dressed on Shabbat - Giving birth on Shabbat - Grinding (Tochen) - Handling objects on Shabbat (Muktzeh) - Infants on Shabbat - Introduction to the Modern Eruv - Kneading (Lash) - Mail on Shabbat - Medicine on Shabbat (Refuah on Shabbat) - Melacha That Begins Before Shabbat - Opening bottles and containers (Boneh) - Plants on Shabbat (Zoreah) - Preparing for after Shabbat (Hachana) - Reading on Shabbat (Daber Davar) - Recreation on Shabbat - Sechirut Reshut - Separating mixtures (Borer) - Squeezing fruits (Sechita) - Speaking on Shabbat (Daber Davar) - Taking a cruise over Shabbat - Taking measurements on Shabbat - Techum - Transactions on Shabbat - Transportation on Shabbat - Going to and Staying in the Hospital on Shabbat - Wages on Shabbat (Sachar Shabbat) - Washing one's body on Shabbat
Melachos	Introduction to Melechet Machshevet - Marbeh Bshiurim - Plowing - Planting - Harvesting - Gathering - Threshing - Winnowing - Separating - Grinding - Sifting - Kneading - Baking and Cooking - Shearing - Laundering - Combing - Dyeing - Spinning - Mounting warp threads - Making two loops - Weaving - Unraveling fabric - Tying - Untying - Gluing, taping, or stapling - Ripping - Trapping - Slaughtering - Skinning - Tanning - Smoothing - Scoring - Cutting precisely - Writing - Erasing - Building - Demolishing - Completing a vessel - Extinguishing a flame - Kindling a fire - Carrying

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